

GALILEO GALILEI

1564-1642



Ganymede, a moon of Jupiter discovered by Galileo

Galileo's shrivelled fingers are displayed at the Science Museum in Florence, Italy.

Galileo's improvement of the design of the telescope meant parts of the Solar System could be seen clearly for the first time. He observed mountains on the Moon and the four biggest moons of Jupiter. He also found Venus to have phases like our Moon. This led him to believe that the Sun is at the centre of the Solar System. The Church put Galileo on trial for his radical views.

DATA FILE



KEY ACHIEVEMENT: Proved Earth orbited the Sun



COUNTRY OF ORIGIN: Italy



YEAR OF ACHIEVEMENT: 1610